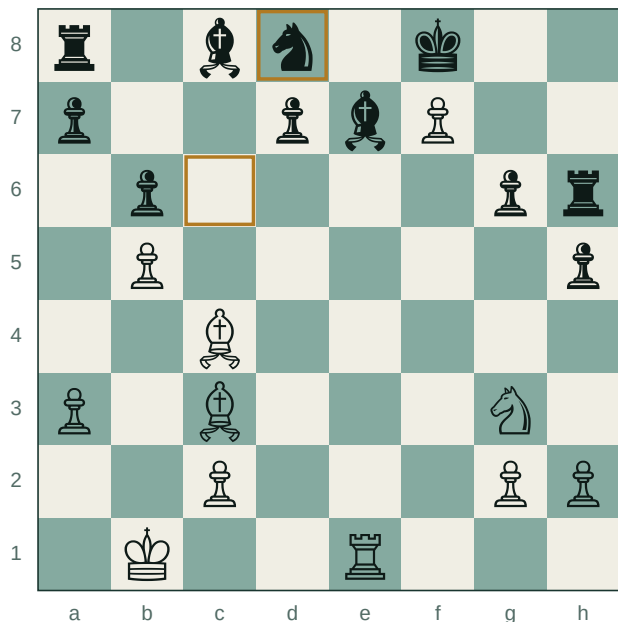


Attraction tactics: White, move 24

Attraction tactics

White to move



Previous move: 23...Nd8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

24. Rxe7 Kxe7 25. Bb4+ d6 26. Bxd6+

24.Rxe7 The rook captures the bishop on e7. Recorded reply: **24...Kxe7**.

25.Bb4+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **25...d6**.

26.Bxd6+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on d6.

At the end, nominal material is White 15 / Black 20 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by -1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -1: the balance goes from -4 to -5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on f8. Geometrically undefended: rook on a8 and rook on h6. Check for tactical protection.